Album converter

Stamp Album · User manual · Version 1.0 · Boris du Reau · October 2026

1. Overview

The album converter turns stamp albums made with other programs into Stamp Album albums (**.sta**). It handles one file or hundreds at a time, without opening the editor.

- **AlbumEasy**: **.txt** description files, with the stamp pictures referenced by *STAMP_ADD_IMG*.
- **Feuille Album 4**: Excel albums in **.xls** format (Excel 97-2003), one sheet per page, with the pictures they contain.

Each converted album takes the name of the source file with the **.sta** extension (*France 2020.xls* becomes *France 2020.sta*). It is saved as soon as it is finished: if you stop the conversion, the albums already converted are kept. Converted albums open in Stamp Album like any other album and can then be edited and printed.

2. Installation and start-up

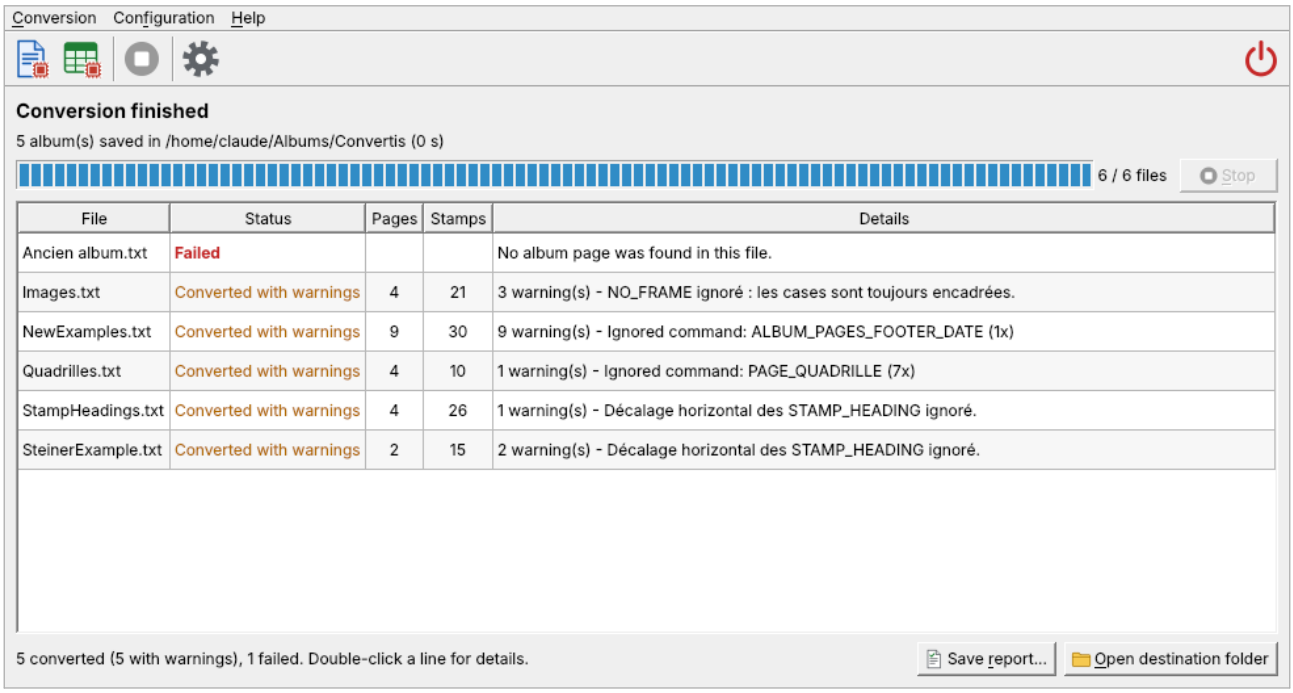
The converter is a separate program, installed in the Stamp Album folder; it reuses the Stamp Album modules (pages, stamps, borders, importers).

Item	Location
AlbumConverter.py, AlbumWriter.py	Stamp Album program folder (with StampAlbum.py, AlbumEasyImporter.py, XlsAlbumImporter.py, Page.py, Stamp.py…)
conv_*.png icons	**Images** folder, at the same level as the program folder (../Images)
PDF manuals	**Help** folder (../Help)
French translation	locale/fr/LC_MESSAGES/AlbumConverter.mo

The converter needs Python 3, PyQt6 and, for Feuille Album 4 files, the **olefile** module:

```
pip install PyQt6 olefile
python AlbumConverter.py
```

3. The main window



The main window at the end of a conversion

From top to bottom: the menus, the toolbar, the conversion status (current file and page), the progress bar with the **Stop** button, the results table, then the batch summary with the **Save report** and **Open destination folder** buttons.

Toolbar

The buttons show an icon only; their name appears in a tooltip when the mouse rests on them.

Button	Action	Shortcut
	Convert AlbumEasy files	Ctrl+E
	Convert Feuille Album 4 files	Ctrl+F
	Stop the conversion after the current file	
	Configuration (settings)	Ctrl+,
	Quit (asks for confirmation)	Ctrl+Q

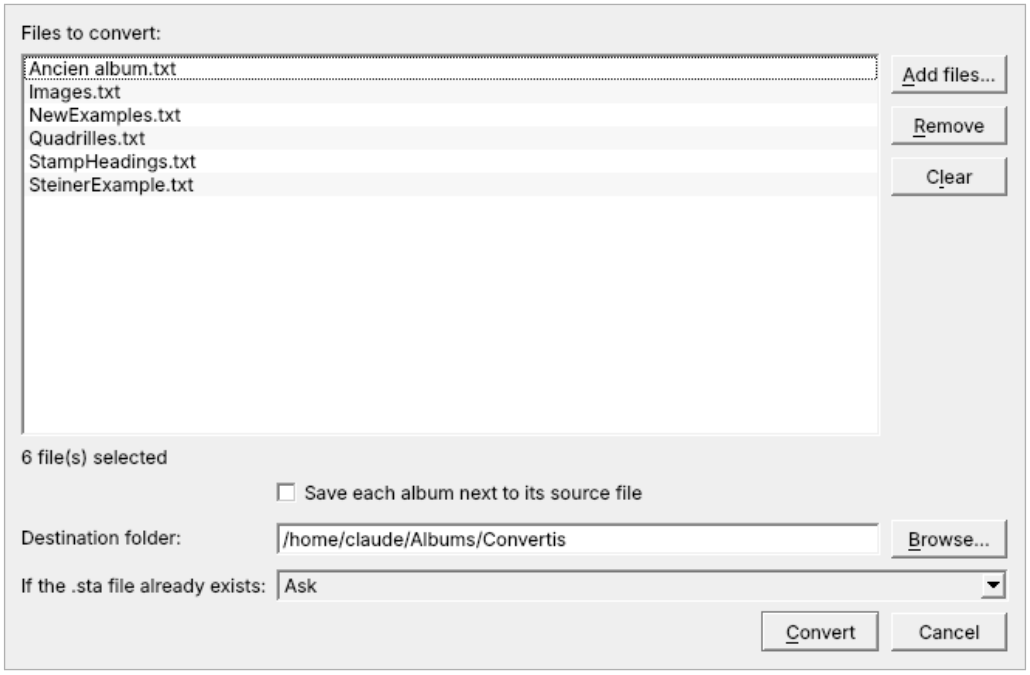
Menus

Menu	Items
Conversion	Convert AlbumEasy files... · Convert Feuille Album 4 files... · Stop conversion · Quit
Configuration	Settings... · Language (English / Français)
Help	User manual (F1) · About...

While a conversion runs, the conversion commands and the configuration are disabled.

4. Converting albums

1. Choose **Convert AlbumEasy files...** or **Convert Feuille Album 4 files...** in the Conversion menu or the toolbar.
2. Click **Add files...** and select the albums. You can add files several times, from several folders; **Remove** and **Clear** correct the list.
3. Choose the **destination folder**, or tick **Save each album next to its source file**. A folder that does not exist can be created.
4. Choose what to do **if the .sta file already exists**: ask, replace, skip or rename.
5. Click **Convert**.

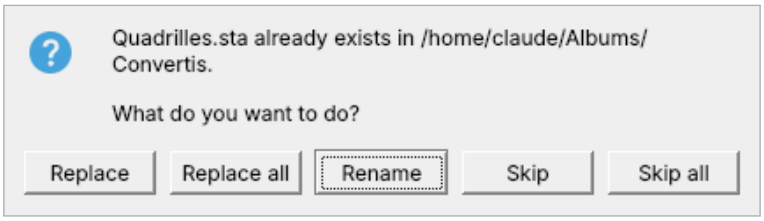


Selecting the files and the destination

Two files that would produce the same .sta file (for example two *Album.txt* from different folders converted into the same destination) are reported before the conversion starts.

Existing .sta file

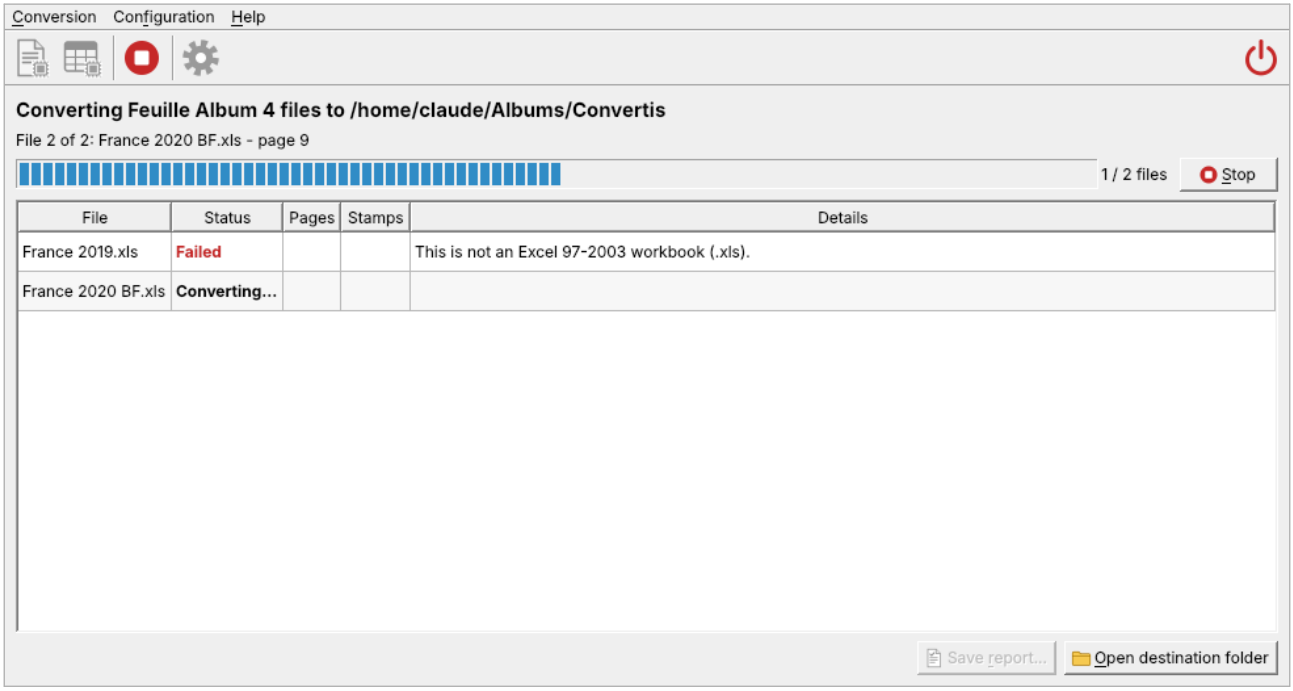
With **Ask**, a question is shown for each album already present in the destination. **Replace all** and **Skip all** apply the same answer to the rest of the batch. **Rename** saves the album as *Album (2).sta*, *Album (3).sta*...



Question when a converted album already exists

5. Following and stopping a conversion

The progress bar shows how many files have been processed, and the line above it the file and page being converted. The table fills in as the batch goes on.



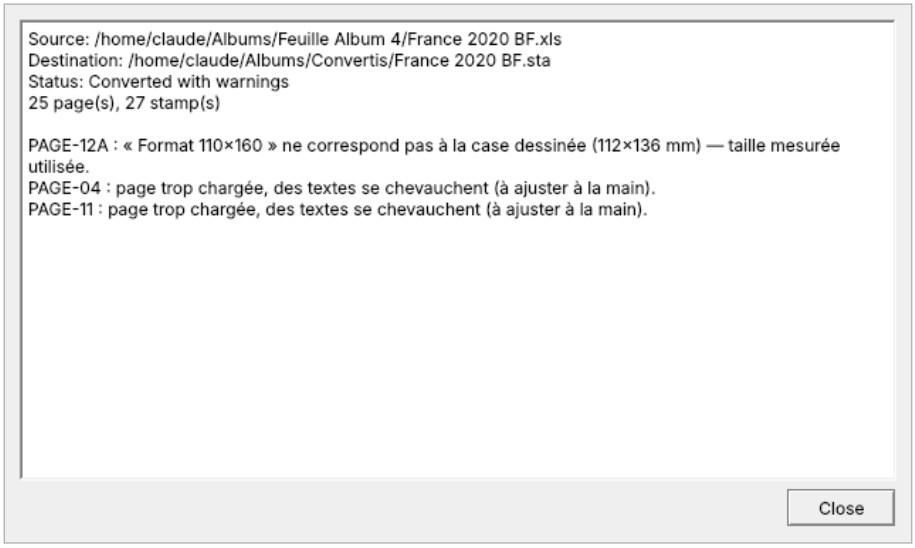
Conversion in progress

The **Stop** button finishes and saves the current file, then stops the batch: the following files are marked *Not converted (stopped)*. An album is never half saved: it is first written under a temporary name, then renamed once complete. Closing the window during a conversion offers to stop and then quit.

6. Results and report

Status	Meaning
Converted	The album was converted and saved without remarks.
Converted with warnings	The album is saved, but some items were adapted or ignored (picture not found, unsupported command...). The details list them.
Failed	The file could not be converted; the reason is given. No .sta file is created.
Skipped	A .sta file with the same name already existed and you chose not to replace it.
Not converted (stopped)	The conversion was stopped before this file.

At the end of the batch, a message lists the failed files. **Double-click a line** to see the full details: source and destination paths, number of pages and stamps, and every warning.

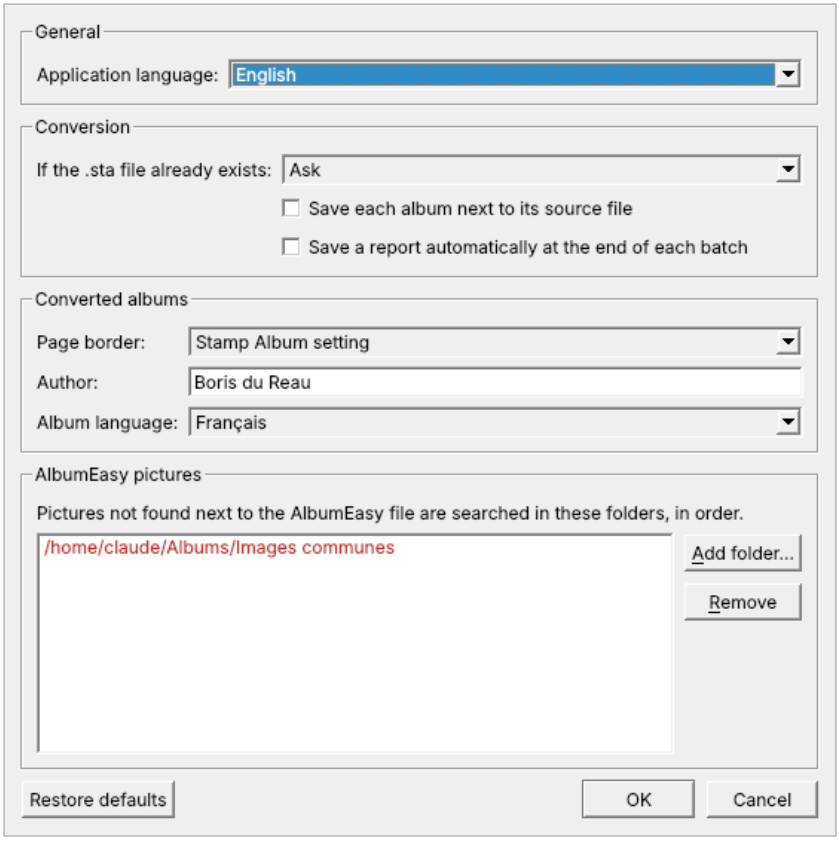


Details of a converted file

Save report... writes a text file with the result of every file. The report can also be saved automatically (see the configuration) in the destination folder, as *conversion_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.txt*.

7. Configuration

Configuration › Settings... opens the window below. These settings belong to the converter: they do not change those of the Stamp Album editor. The language can also be changed directly with **Configuration › Language**; it applies immediately. The settings are saved in the text file **AlbumConverter.cfg**, in the application folder (the one that contains Images and Help); its path is shown at the bottom of the window. If that folder is write-protected, the file is placed in the user's settings folder.



The configuration window

Setting	Effect
Application language	English or French, for menus, windows and messages.
If the .sta file already exists	Default choice in the selection window: Ask, Replace, Skip or Rename.
Save each album next to its source file	Ticked by default in the selection window: the .sta file is created in the folder of the source file.
Save a report automatically	Writes the report at the end of each batch.
Page border	Border style of the converted pages (triple, simple, greek, dentelle), or the style set in Stamp Album.
Author	Saved in the album. Used only when the source file names no author (AlbumEasy ALBUM_AUTHOR command).
Album language	Language saved in the album (used by the Stamp Album spell checker).
AlbumEasy pictures	Folders searched, in order, for pictures not found next to the .txt file. A folder that no longer exists is shown in red.

Restore defaults resets every setting except the language.

8. What is converted

AlbumEasy (.txt)

The file is read as UTF-8 (or Windows-1252 for older files). The following are kept: page size, margins and border, the title of each page, texts and paragraphs (left-aligned or centred, in colour), spacing, columns, stamp rows and their alignment, stamps with or without picture and their headings, freely placed boxes, the background picture, defined fonts, page numbering, greyscale or hidden pictures. A row that no longer fits on the page moves to a continuation page.

Ignored commands: PAGE_QUADRILLE, PAGE_RULE_H, page headers and footer date, margin text. Adaptations: justified paragraphs are left-aligned, NO_FRAME and the horizontal offset of headings are ignored, the rotation of boxes is not kept in the .sta file.

Feuille Album 4 (.xls)

Each PAGE-xx sheet becomes a page, in order (PAGE-01, PAGE-02... PAGE-12, PAGE-12A...), with its paper size and orientation. Each group of shapes becomes a stamp: the description above the box, the number ("N°...") and the value below it, the original picture in the box. The box size comes from the "Format WxH" text; if it does not match the drawn box, the drawn size is used and a warning is given. The year, the copyright and the page number are kept.

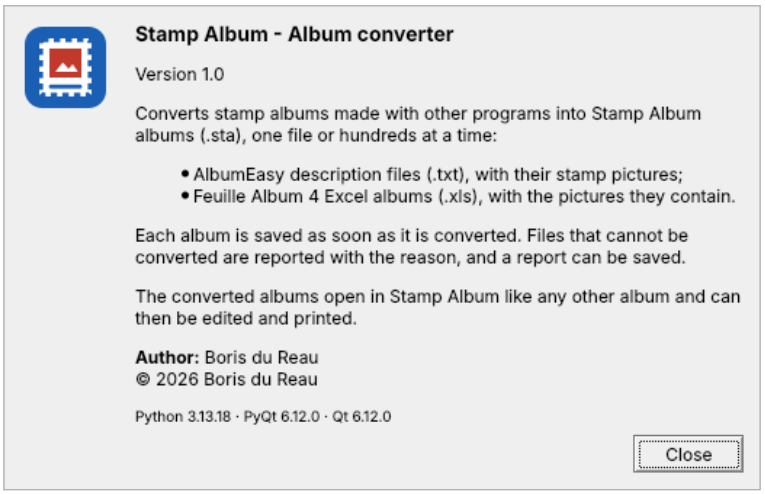
Only Excel 97-2003 workbooks (.xls) can be read. An .xlsx file must first be saved in .xls format in Excel.

Good to know. For plain texts the .sta format only keeps bold, italic and size: when the album is reopened in Stamp Album, these texts use the default font and their standard alignment. Stamps, pictures, borders and coloured texts are kept exactly. The warnings produced by the importers are written in French, whatever the language chosen.

9. Troubleshooting

Message or situation	Solution
The 'olefile' module is required	Install it with *pip install olefile*, then restart the converter.
This is not an Excel 97-2003 workbook (.xls)	The file is damaged or in .xlsx format: open it in Excel and save it in .xls format.
No album page was found in this file	The file contains no recognised AlbumEasy command, or no PAGE-xx sheet.
Image not found: ...	Add the picture folder in Configuration › AlbumEasy pictures, then convert the file again.
The toolbar shows standard icons	The conv_*.png files are missing from the Images folder.
The manual does not open	Put the PDF in the Help folder, next to the Images folder.

10. About



Help › About

Stamp Album and its album converter are written by **Boris du Reau**.